Paul Brass has very-well explained the meaning of a wave election in the following way: "A wave election is one in which a clear tendency begins to develop among the electorate in a single direction and in favour of a national party or its leader. It is based upon an issue or set of issues that transcend local calculations and coalition and draws the bulk of the uncommitted and wavering voters in the same direction as the word spreads from village to village and tea stall to tea stall".[7]

7. Performance of the Ruling Party: On the eve of elections, every political party releases its election manifesto containing the promises made by it to the electorate. The performance of the ruling party is judged by the electorate on the basis of its election manifesto. The defeat of Congress Party in 1977 elections and that of Janata Party in 1980 elections illustrates that the performance of the ruling party influences the voting behaviour. Thus, the anti-incumbency factor (which means dissatisfaction with the performance of the ruling party) is a determinant of electoral behaviour.

8. Party Identification: Personal and emotional association with political parties plays a role in determining voting behaviour. People who identify themselves with a particular party will always vote for that party irrespective of its omissions and commissions.

9. Ideology: The political ideology professed by a political party has a bearing on the decision-making of the voters. Some people in the society are committed to certain ideologies like communism, capitalism, democracy, secularism, patriotism, decentralisation and so on. Such people generally support the candidates put up by the parties professing those ideologies.

10. Other Factors: In addition to the above-explained factors, there are also various other factors which determine the voting behaviour of the Indian electorate. These are mentioned below:

1. Political events preceding an election like war, murder of a leader, corruption scandals, etc.
2. Economic conditions at the time of election like inflation, food shortage, unemployment, etc.
3. Factionalism – a feature of Indian politics from bottom to top levels
4. Candidate orientation
5. Election campaign
6. Political family background
7. Role of media

[1]Gordon Marshall, *Oxford Dictionary of Sociology*, First Indian Edition, 2004, p. 696.

[2]Oinam Kulabidhu, *Electoral Politics in Manipur*, 1980–1995 (Unpublished Ph.D. Thesis submitted to the Manipur University, 1998).

[3]David Robertson, *The Penguin Dictionary of Politics*, Second Edition, 1993, p. 485.

[4]K.R. Acharya (Ed.), *Perspectives on Indian Government and Politics*, Second Edition, 1991, S. Chand & Company Ltd., p. 403.

[5]Paul R. Brass, *The Politics of India Since Independence*, Second Edition, Cambridge University Press, pp. 97–98.